MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (Honours)/MGU-BBA (Honours)/MGU-BCA (Honours) Special Examinations, July 2026 (for 2024 Admission Regular Examinations, October 2025
Third SEMESTER

Discipline Specific Core Course (DSC) - MG3DSCHIS202 -ORIGINS OF THE MODERN WORLD
(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

Duration: 2 Hours **Maximum Marks: 70**

Remember(K), Understand(U), Apply(A), Analyse(An), Evaluate(E), Create(C), Skill(S), Interest(I) and Appreciation(Ap)

PART A : SHORT ANSWERS

Answer any 10 questions. Each question carries 2 marks

1. Define feudal rent. [U] / [CO1]-Feudal rent was the payment made by peasants to the feudal lord for the use of land.It could be paid in the form of labour services, agricultural produce, or money.It was the principal source of income for feudal lords.It reflected the economic relationship between the lord and the peasant in the feudal system.

2. Define apprentices. [K] / [CO1]-Apprentices were young persons who learned a trade under a master craftsman.They received practical training in workshops or guilds.The period of apprenticeship usually lasted several years.After successful training, they could become skilled craftsmen or masters.

3. What is meant by tributary society? [U] / [CO2]-A tributary society was a political and economic system in which producers paid tribute to the ruling class.Tribute could be paid in the form of agricultural produce, labour, or taxes.The ruling authority controlled the surplus produced by peasants.Such societies existed in many pre-modern Asian and African states.

4. What is meant by the 'prime mover' in the transition debate? [U] / [CO2]-The "prime mover" refers to the principal factor responsible for the transition from feudalism to capitalism.Historians have identified different prime movers such as class struggle, expansion of trade, demographic changes, and technological developments.The debate seeks to explain the origin of capitalist society.

5. Niccolò Machiavelli. [K] / [CO3]-Niccolò Machiavelli was an Italian political thinker of the Renaissance.He was the author of The Prince.He separated politics from religion and morality.He argued that rulers should use practical methods to maintain power.He is regarded as the father of modern political science.

6. What is meant by the English Reformation? [U] / [CO3]-The English Reformation was the religious movement that separated the Church of England from the Roman Catholic Church.It began during the reign of Henry VIII.The Act of Supremacy (1534) declared the English king as the Supreme Head of the Church.It resulted in the establishment of the Anglican Church.

7. What is meant by the Sale of Indulgence? [K] / [CO3]-Indulgences were certificates issued by the Catholic Church promising remission of temporal punishment for sins.They were often sold in exchange for money.The practice was used to raise funds for church activities, including the rebuilding of St. Peter's Basilica.Martin Luther strongly criticised the sale of indulgences in his Ninety-five Theses (1517).It became one of the immediate causes of the Protestant Reformation.

8. Find the significance of *Micrographia* in the history of natural science. [K] / [CO4]-*Micrographia* was written by Robert Hooke in 1665.It was one of the earliest scientific books based on microscopic observations.Hooke introduced the term "cell" after observing cork.The work encouraged scientific observation and experimentation.It contributed significantly to the development of biology and microscopy.

9. The Coup of 18 Brumaire. [K] / [CO4]-The Coup of 18 Brumaire took place on 9 November 1799. Napoleon Bonaparte overthrew the French Directory.It established the Consulate with Napoleon as First Consul.It marked the end of the French Revolution.It paved the way for Napoleon's rise as Emperor.

10. *Starry Messenger*. [K] / [CO4]- *Starry Messenger* (*Sidereus Nuncius*) was published by Galileo Galilei in 1610.*It recorded observations made through the telescope.Galileo described the mountains and craters on the Moon.He reported the discovery of the four moons of Jupiter.The work provided strong support for the heliocentric theory.*

11. Pedro Álvares Cabral. [K] / [CO5]-Pedro Álvares Cabral was a Portuguese navigator.He reached Brazil in 1500 while sailing to India.Brazil was claimed for Portugal under the Treaty of Tordesillas.He later continued his voyage to India.His voyage strengthened Portuguese overseas expansion.

12. How labour turned to a commodity in capitalism. [U] / [CO5]-Under capitalism, workers were separated from the means of production.They could no longer produce independently for their livelihood.They sold their labour power in exchange for wages.Labour became something that could be bought and sold in the market.This transformation became a defining feature of the capitalist economy.

PART B : SHORT ESSAY

Answer any 6 questions. Each question carries 5 marks

13. Why a static society without private property has been employed on Asian societies in the Asiatic Mode of Production. [An] / [CO2] - The concept of the Asiatic Mode of Production (AMP) was developed by Karl Marx to explain the socio-economic structure of many ancient Asian societies-private ownership of land was either absent or very limited, while land was owned by the state or by village communities.The village community functioned as a self-sufficient economic unit,-Agriculture depended heavily on large-scale irrigation works, canals and reservoirs, which required central coordination.The organisation and maintenance of irrigation systems were controlled by a powerful centralised state, often referred to as Oriental Despotism.The ruling authority appropriated surplus mainly through taxation and tribute, rather than through feudal rent.Since village communities remained largely unchanged for centuries, and social structures showed little internal dynamism.The absence of private landed property prevented the emergence of feudal landlordism similar to that of medieval Europe.

14. List out the qualitative changes occurred in the field of biological science during the Scientific Revolution. [U] / [CO4] - The Scientific Revolution replaced medieval beliefs based on Aristotle and Galen with knowledge derived from observation, experimentation and reason.Andreas Vesalius published *De Humani Corporis Fabrica* (1543), correcting many errors in human anatomy through direct dissection.William Harvey published *De Motu Cordis* (1628), proving that blood circulates continuously through the body and that the heart functions as a pump.The invention and improvement of the compound microscope opened entirely new areas of biological investigation.Robert Hooke published *Micrographia* (1665), in which he described microscopic structures and introduced the term "cell" after observing cork tissue.Antonie van Leeuwenhoek, using powerful microscopes of his own design, observed bacteria, protozoa, sperm cells and red blood cells, earning recognition as the Father of Microbiology.Scientific classification of plants and animals became increasingly systematic through detailed observation and comparison.Biology gradually emerged as an independent scientific discipline based on experimentation rather than traditional authority.

15. Analyse the outlook of the European Enlightenment towards the religious institutions. [An] / [CO3] -.Enlightenment thinkers challenged the political and religious authority exercised by the Roman Catholic Church.They criticised superstition, dogmatism, clerical privilege and the suppression of free enquiry-Voltaire attacked religious intolerance, fanaticism and corruption within the Church, advocating freedom of belief and expression.John Locke, in his *Letter Concerning Toleration* (1689), argued that the state should not interfere with individual religious beliefs.Many Enlightenment thinkers supported Deism, believing that God created the universe but did not intervene continuously in human affairs.Denis Diderot, through the publication of the Encyclopédie, spread scientific knowledge and criticised ecclesiastical authority.Enlightenment philosophers advocated the separation of Church and State, limiting the influence of religion in political affairs.

16. Observe the development in the fields of music and literature during the European Renaissance. [U] / [CO3] - Development of Literature - Renaissance literature was deeply influenced by Humanism.The use of vernacular languages instead of Latin made literature accessible to ordinary people.Dante Alighieri, through the *Divine Comedy*, bridged medieval and Renaissance thought.Francesco Petrarch, known as the Father of Humanism, revived classical scholarship and encouraged critical study of ancient texts.Giovanni Boccaccio, in the *Decameron*, portrayed everyday human life with realism.Desiderius Erasmus, in *Praise of Folly*, criticised corruption within the Church through satire.Thomas More, in *Utopia* (1516), imagined an ideal society based on justice and equality.Niccolò Machiavelli, in *The Prince*, developed a realistic approach to politics.William Shakespeare enriched English literature through tragedies, comedies and historical plays. Development of Music-Renaissance music became more harmonious, balanced and expressive than medieval music.Polyphonic music, combining several independent melodies, reached a high level of development.Sacred music was reformed, while secular music became increasingly popular.Giovanni Pierluigi da Palestrina composed church music that reflected the ideals of the Counter-Reformation.Improvements in musical notation and the printing press facilitated the wider dissemination of music throughout Europe.

17. Critically examine the role of common culture as a cementing force of nationalism. [E] / [CO4] - Nationalism developed through the emergence of a shared cultural identity among the people.A common language enabled effective communication and created a sense of unity, as seen in the nationalist movements of Germany and Italy.Shared historical memories and the celebration of common heroes strengthened collective identity.National traditions, customs and festivals promoted emotional attachment to the nation.Folklore, folk songs and oral traditions helped preserve national consciousness.The printing press and newspapers spread nationalist ideas among wider sections of society.National symbols such as flags, national anthems and emblems became powerful expressions of unity.

18. Outline the gradual evolution of electrical power during the Industrial Revolution. [U] / [CO4] - Benjamin Franklin demonstrated that lightning was an electrical phenomenon through his famous kite experiment (1752).Luigi Galvani discovered the phenomenon of animal electricity.Alessandro Volta invented the Voltaic Cell (1800),.Hans Christian Oersted (1820) established the relationship between electricity and magnetism, opening the field of electromagnetism.Michael Faraday discovered the principle of electromagnetic induction (1831)-The invention of the dynamo enabled the large-scale generation of electricity for industrial purposes.Thomas Alva Edison developed practical electric lighting and established the first commercial power station in 1882.Nikola Tesla and George Westinghouse promoted the use of Alternating Current (AC), which proved more efficient for long-distance transmission than Direct Current (DC).The introduction of electric motors increased industrial productivity and reduced dependence on steam engines.

19. Discuss the role of English Civil Wars in the development of parliamentary democracy. [U] / [CO4] - Charles I followed the Divine Right TheoryThe supporters of the King were known as Royalists (Cavaliers), while the supporters of Parliament were called Parliamentarians (Roundheads).Oliver Cromwell organised the New Model Army (1645),

which became the strongest military force of Parliament.The Battle of Naseby (1645) decisively defeated the Royalist army and ensured Parliamentary supremacy in the war.Charles I was executed in 1649, ending the idea of the absolute authority of the monarchy.England was declared a Commonwealth (1649–1653) under parliamentary rule after the abolition of the monarchy and the House of Lords.Oliver Cromwell assumed the office of Lord Protector (1653–1658) under the Protectorate.The Restoration (1660) brought Charles II back to the throne, but Parliament continued to exercise increasing influence over governance.The Glorious Revolution (1688) peacefully replaced James II with William III and Mary II, establishing parliamentary supremacy.The Bill of Rights (1689) prohibited the monarch from suspending laws, levying taxes or maintaining a standing army without the consent of Parliament.The Toleration Act (1689) granted limited religious freedom to Protestant dissenters and reduced religious conflicts in politics.The Act of Settlement (1701) ensured parliamentary control over succession to the English throne.These constitutional developments established the principle of constitutional monarchy, in which the monarch ruled according to law and with the consent of Parliament.The English Civil Wars and the constitutional settlements that followed laid the foundation for the growth of modern parliamentary democracy in Britain.

20. Observe the character of the European colonization of South America.
[E] / [CO5] -European colonisation of South America began after the voyages of Christopher Columbus (1492) and expanded rapidly during the sixteenth century.Spain and Portugal emerged as the principal colonial powers in South America.The Treaty of Tordesillas (1494) divided newly discovered territories outside Europe between Spain and Portugal.Pedro Álvares Cabral reached Brazil in 1500, leading to Portuguese control over the region.Spanish conquistadors such as Francisco Pizarro conquered the Inca Empire during the sixteenth century.The Encomienda System granted Spanish settlers the right to collect tribute and labour from indigenous communities.Europeans exploited the rich deposits of gold and silver, particularly in regions such as Potosí, to strengthen their economies.Plantation agriculture expanded with the cultivation of sugar, coffee and tobacco, creating large colonial estates.The decline of the indigenous population due to warfare and disease resulted in the large-scale importation of African slaves through the Atlantic slave trade.Roman Catholic missionaries, particularly the Jesuits and Franciscans, spread Christianity and established churches and missions.European languages, legal systems and administrative institutions replaced many indigenous traditions.South America became integrated into the expanding Atlantic economy and the emerging capitalist world system, supplying raw materials to Europe.

21. Examine the cultural impacts of colonialism based on the theoretical understandings of Frantz Fanon. [U] / [CO5] -Fanon argued that colonialism was not merely political or economic domination but also a system of cultural domination.Colonial rulers attempted to portray indigenous cultures as backward, primitive and inferior while presenting European civilisation as superior.The language of the coloniser became a symbol of power and social prestige, leading many colonised people to neglect their own languages.Colonialism produced psychological alienation, making the colonised internalise feelings of inferiority.Indigenous customs, religions, art forms and social institutions were frequently marginalised or suppressed. Cultural resistance formed an essential part of anti-colonial nationalism-the recovery of national culture was necessary for restoring the dignity and identity of colonised peoples.

22. Examine the critique raised by Adam Smith and classical economists on the mercantilist economic system. [U] / [CO5] - In The Wealth of Nations (1776), Adam Smith

criticised mercantilism for excessive government interventionin economic activities.Smith argued that the true wealth of a nation depended on its productive capacity and labour, rather than on the accumulation of precious metals.He opposed monopolies, exclusive trading companies and restrictive commercial regulations that limited competition and advocated free trade, believing that unrestricted exchange would benefit all trading nations.He developed the concept of the Invisible Hand, explaining that individuals pursuing their own economic interests could unintentionally promote the welfare of society.He supported the principle of laissez-faire, according to which the government should play only a limited role in economic affairs.The ideas of Adam Smith and later classical economists such as David Ricardo and Thomas Robert Malthuscontributed significantly to the decline of mercantilism and the emergence of modern capitalist economic thought.

PART C : ESSAY QUESTIONS

Answer any 2 questions. Each question carries 10 marks

23. Examine the impact of European Enlightenment on the literature and philosophy of Europe. [An] / [CO3] - The Enlightenment was an eighteenth-century intellectual movement based on reason, rationality and scientific enquiry.Thinkers emphasised individual liberty, human rights and freedom of thought.John Locke advocated natural rights, constitutional government and religious tolerance.Montesquieu, in *The Spirit of Laws* (1748), proposed the doctrine of Separation of Powers.Voltaire criticised religious intolerance and defended civil liberties and freedom of expression.Jean-Jacques Rousseau, in *The Social Contract* (1762), developed the concept of Popular Sovereignty and the General Will. Denis Diderot edited the Encyclopédie, which spread scientific and philosophical knowledge throughout Europe.Enlightenment ideas encouraged critical thinking and the use of reason instead of tradition.Literature reflected human experience, social criticism and political reform rather than religious themes.Writers increasingly used vernacular languages, making literature accessible to a wider public.Satirical works became popular as a means of criticising social and political institutions.

24. Examine the development of class society following the Industrial Revolution. [An] / [CO4] - Factory production replaced the domestic or putting-out system. A new industrial bourgeoisie developed through ownership of factories, mines and capital.The working class (proletariat) grew rapidly as people migrated from rural areas to industrial towns.The Enclosure Movement forced many peasants off the land, creating wage labourers.Labour became a commodity, and workers depended on wages for survival.Rapid urbanisation accompanied industrial development. Factory workers experienced long working hours, low wages and poor working conditions.Women and children were employed in factories for lower wages.Industrialisation widened the gap between the rich capitalist class and the working class.Labour unions and Trade Unions emerged to protect workers' interests.Reform movements demanded better wages, shorter working hours and improved working conditions.Socialist thinkers such as Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels criticised capitalist exploitation in *The Communist Manifesto* (1848).The Industrial Revolution fundamentally transformed European society into a modern class society dominated by the relationship between capital and labour.

25. Analyse the theoretical framework of Immanuel Wallerstein in explaining the working of capitalist system. [E] / [CO5] - Immanuel Wallerstein developed the World-Systems Theory

in the 1970s.He explained capitalism as a world economic system rather than a collection of separate national economies.The modern world-system emerged during the sixteenth century with European expansion.The capitalist world economy is organised through an international division of labour.Wallerstein classified countries into Core, Semi-Periphery and Periphery.Core countries possess advanced industries, technology and financial resources.Periphery countries mainly supply raw materials, agricultural products and cheap labour.Semi-periphery countries occupy an intermediate position between the Core and Periphery.Core countries exploit the resources and labour of peripheral regions through unequal exchange.Colonialism and imperialism strengthened the expansion of the capitalist world economy.Capital accumulation remains concentrated in the Core.The world-system is dynamic, and countries may shift between categories over time.Wallerstein rejected the idea that societies develop independently.His theory emphasises global economic interdependence and unequal development.

26. Examine the feasibility of the application of the patrimonial model in analysing pre-modern Asian societies. [An] / [CO2] -The Patrimonial Model was developed by Max Weber to explain traditional systems of authority.Patrimonial rule is based on personal authority, loyalty and hereditary power.Administrative officials function as personal servants of the ruler rather than as independent bureaucrats.Political authority is closely linked with ownership of land and control over resources.The ruler exercises authority through personal relationships rather than impersonal legal institutions.Many historians have applied the patrimonial model to explain pre-modern Asian kingdoms.It has been used to study states such as Mughal India, Imperial China and the Ottoman Empire.The model explains the concentration of political authority in the ruler and the dependence of officials on royal patronage.It also highlights the importance of kinship, loyalty and personal service in governance.However, critics argue that Asian societies were diverse and cannot be explained by a single model.Many Asian states possessed sophisticated administrative institutions and regional variations.Economic, social and cultural differences limit the universal application of the patrimonial model.